TECH6 — Data Science and Econometrics
Autumn 2026

Term Paper Guidelines

The term paper replicates and extends Meyersson, E. (2014), "Islamic Rule and the Empowerment of the Poor and Pious", *Econometrica* 82(1), 229–269, using the dataset shared on Canvas. The paper should include the following:

1. **Summary.** What does the author do, what does he find, why does the paper matter, and what is the value of replicating it? Answer the course's four questions for the paper: what is the estimand? What is being compared? What are the assumptions? What are the threats to identification? Clarity and conciseness are rewarded.
2. **Replication (in R).** Reproduce Tables 1, 2, 3, 7 and Figures 1, 2, 3 and 4 in the main text of the paper, following the paper's own specifications: its controls and province fixed effects, standard errors clustered by province, its bandwidths. Where a result cannot be reproduced, please explain.
3. **Extensions.** Extend the paper in two directions, of your own choosing. You can use methods covered in either parts of the course and code in R or Python. Motivate each — why is it useful given what is already in the paper, and what can we learn from it? If the original results cannot be reproduced, one extension may be replaced by a detailed investigation of why.
4. **Discussion.** What do the replication and the extensions together say about the paper's conclusion, and for whom it holds?

Submission deadline: Thursday 20 November 2026, 12:00 (one submission per group).

Include in the submission:

(1) the write-up (PDF, at most 20 pages including everything, in English).

(2) a link to a GitHub repository with the programs, the results they produce, a `README`, and one command (`run_all`) that regenerates every table and figure from `regdata0.dta`.

(3) a short statement of which AI tools you used and for what purpose (or that you used none). AI tools can be used for learning, debugging and checking. Please write the code and the text yourselves and do not paste directly into the submission content that is generated by AI. You are responsible for everything you hand in, and every group member must be able to explain each line of code. You may be asked to during the presentation.

Presentation. Twenty minutes per group in early December. Every group member should present.

E-mails received three days before the deadline or earlier will be answered before the deadline.

Good luck!

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